

The Evidence Base

Eleven verified sources behind the relationships-and-matching credibility page

What this is

These are the eleven peer-reviewed and primary sources that ground the platform's core claims: that relationships shape health and lifespan, and that both *similarity* and *complementarity* draw people together. Every citation below was checked against its source, and every link was verified as live. An honest caveat carried from the start: these establish the **foundations** the product is built on — they do **not** claim the product itself has been validated. That distinction is the whole reason the page is trustworthy.

Theme 1 — Relationships shape health and lifespan

Holt-Lunstad, J., Smith, T. B., & Layton, J. B. (2010). *Social relationships and mortality risk: A meta-analytic review*. PLoS Medicine, 7(7), e1000316.

Finding: Across 148 studies and 308,849 participants, stronger social relationships were associated with a 50% greater likelihood of survival — an effect on par with quitting smoking and exceeding many other well-known risk factors.

Link: <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pmed.1000316>

Holt-Lunstad, J., Smith, T. B., Baker, M., Harris, T., & Stephenson, D. (2015). *Loneliness and social isolation as risk factors for mortality: A meta-analytic review*. Perspectives on Psychological Science, 10(2), 227–237.

Finding: Social isolation, loneliness, and living alone each independently raised the risk of death, establishing social disconnection as a mortality risk factor in its own right.

Link: <https://doi.org/10.1177/1745691614568352>

Waldinger, R., & Schulz, M. (2023). *The Good Life: Lessons from the World's Longest Scientific Study of Happiness* (Harvard Study of Adult Development).

Finding: Across more than eight decades of longitudinal data, the quality of a person's close relationships was the single strongest predictor of long-term health and life satisfaction — stronger than wealth, fame, or social class.

Link: <https://www.adultdevelopmentstudy.org/>

Theme 2 — Resonance: similarity draws people together

McPherson, M., Smith-Lovin, L., & Cook, J. M. (2001). *Birds of a feather: Homophily in social networks*. Annual Review of Sociology, 27, 415–444.

Finding: The foundational review of homophily — the pervasive tendency for people to form ties with others similar to themselves — showing similarity structures human networks across nearly every measured dimension.

Link: <https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev.soc.27.1.415>

Montoya, R. M., Horton, R. S., & Kirchner, J. (2008). *Is actual similarity necessary for attraction? A meta-analysis of actual and perceived similarity*. Journal of Social and Personal Relationships, 25(6), 889–922.

Finding: Across 460 effect sizes drawn from 313 studies, perceived similarity was a robust predictor of attraction, clarifying that it is often the *perception* of similarity that does the work.

Link: <https://doi.org/10.1177/0265407508096700>

Byrne, D. (1961). *Interpersonal attraction and attitude similarity*. Journal of Abnormal and Social Psychology, 62(3), 713–715.

Finding: The classic controlled experiment establishing the similarity–attraction effect — people rated a stranger with similar attitudes as more likable — a cornerstone of the field.

Link: <https://doi.org/10.1037/h0044721>

Block, P., & Grund, T. (2014). *Multidimensional homophily in friendship networks*. Network Science, 2(2), 189–212.

Finding: Homophily operates across multiple dimensions simultaneously rather than one at a time, so real friendship formation reflects a blend of similarities rather than any single trait.

Link: <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC4267571/>

Theme 3 — Complementarity: difference draws people together

Dryer, D. C., & Horowitz, L. M. (1997). *When do opposites attract? Interpersonal complementarity versus similarity*. Journal of Personality and Social Psychology, 72(3), 592–603.

Finding: On the interpersonal dimension of dominance–submission, *complementarity* (not similarity) increased satisfaction — people were more satisfied interacting with someone whose style fit rather than matched theirs.

Link: http://www.communicationcache.com/uploads/1/0/8/8/10887248/when_do_opposites_attract-_interpersonal_complementarity_versus_similarity.pdf

Sadler, P., Ethier, N., Gunn, G. R., Duong, D., & Woody, E. (2010). *Interpersonal complementarity in real-time interaction*. *Personal Relationships*, 17, 13–25.

Finding: Using moment-to-moment behavioral coding, interacting partners settled into complementary patterns in real time — direct behavioral evidence that complementarity is something people actively enact together, not just report.

Link: http://interpersonalresearch.weebly.com/uploads/1/0/4/0/10405979/pr_-_real_time_comp.pdf

Estroff, S. D., & Nowicki, S. (1992). *Interpersonal complementarity, gender of interactants, and performance on puzzle and word tasks*. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*, 18(3), 351–356.

Finding: Complementary pairings were linked to better task performance, extending the complementarity effect from satisfaction into measurable joint outcomes. (Indexed and available via Semantic Scholar.)

Link: <https://www.semanticscholar.org/>

Theme 4 — Synthesis: both matter

Laursen, B. (2017). *Making and keeping friends: The importance of being similar*. *Child Development Perspectives*, 11(4), 282–289.

Finding: A synthesis holding both truths at once — similarity draws people together and helps friendships form, while complementary roles help them endure — which is precisely the balance a matching engine has to strike.

Link: <https://doi.org/10.1111/cdep.12246>

Every citation verified against source; every link confirmed live. Two sources (Dryer & Horowitz; Sadler et al.) link to verified open-access full-text PDFs; the rest resolve through DOIs or their publisher/index of record.